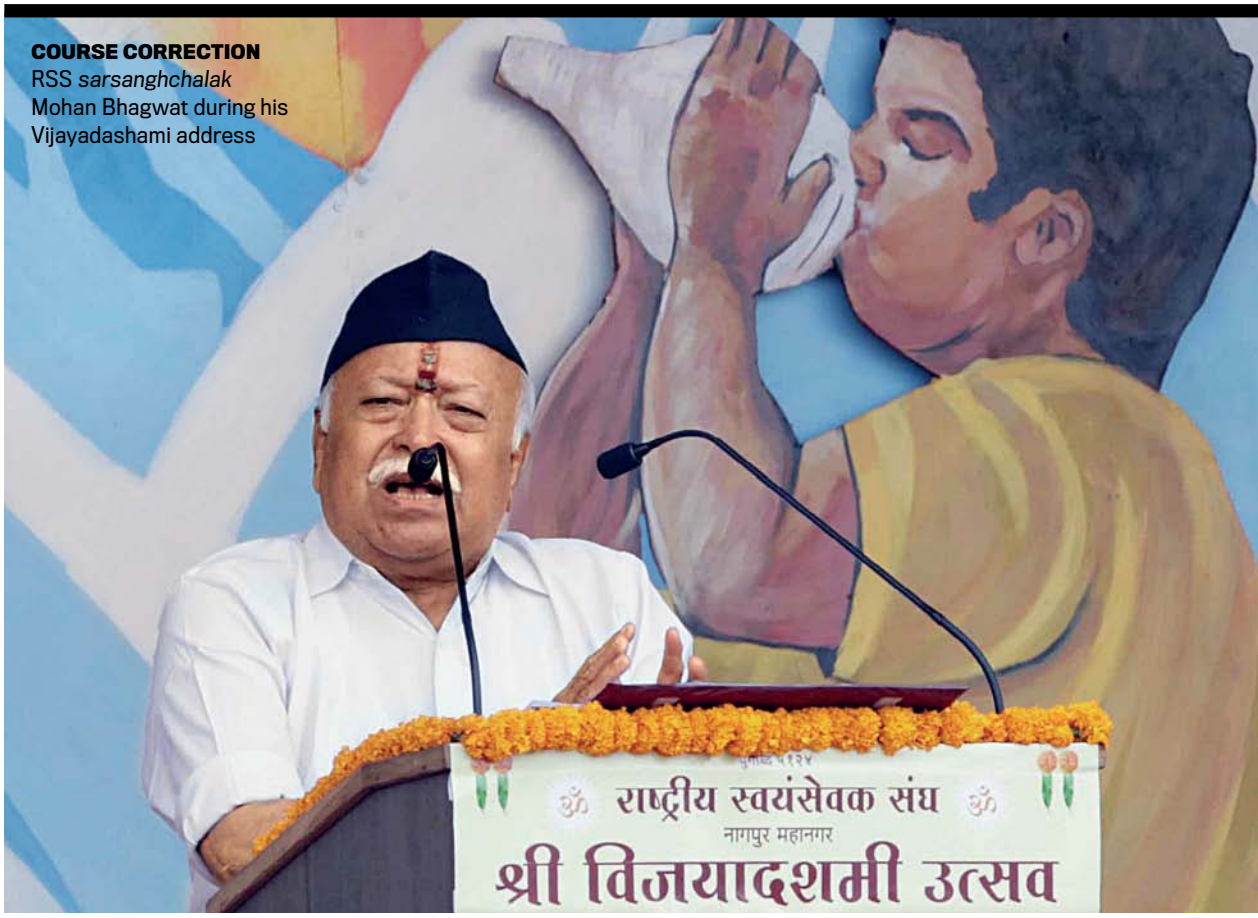
ECONOMY: DOMINO EFFECT
PG 11

HP: THAKUR VS THAKUR
PG 16

UPFRONT

MAHARASHTRA: FEEDING CHANGE
PG 12

CDS: THE GENERAL FOR THE JOB
PG 18



COURSE CORRECTION
RSS *sarsanghchalak* Mohan Bhagwat during his Vijayadashami address

SHEKHAR SONI

RSS-BJP

RSS PRICKS BJP'S CONSCIENCE

By Anilesh S. Mahajan

It was Dattatreya Hosabale, *sarkaryavah* (general secretary) of the Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh (RSS), who first stirred up the pot on October 2, highlighting some disturbing figures on the poverty, inequality and unemployment situation in the country. Three days later, RSS *sarsanghchalak* Mohan Bhagwat touched on the same issues during his customary Vijayadashami address but in the larger context of encouraging the youth to become entrepreneurs rather than job-seekers. With Hosabale's comments becoming headline news, there were rumours yet again that the Sangh and the BJP government at the Centre are not on the same page on the direction the economy is taking. Eyebrows were also raised about the timing of the comments, especially after Congress leaders like Jairam Ramesh attributed them to the "impact" of Rahul Gandhi's Bharat Jodo Yatra.

It's no secret that job creation remains one of the toughest challenges before the Narendra Modi government. Indeed, many of his cabinet ministers have been at pains to highlight the post-Covid "recovery" of the economy (the latest conceit being how India has become the world's fifth largest economy, overtaking the UK). What